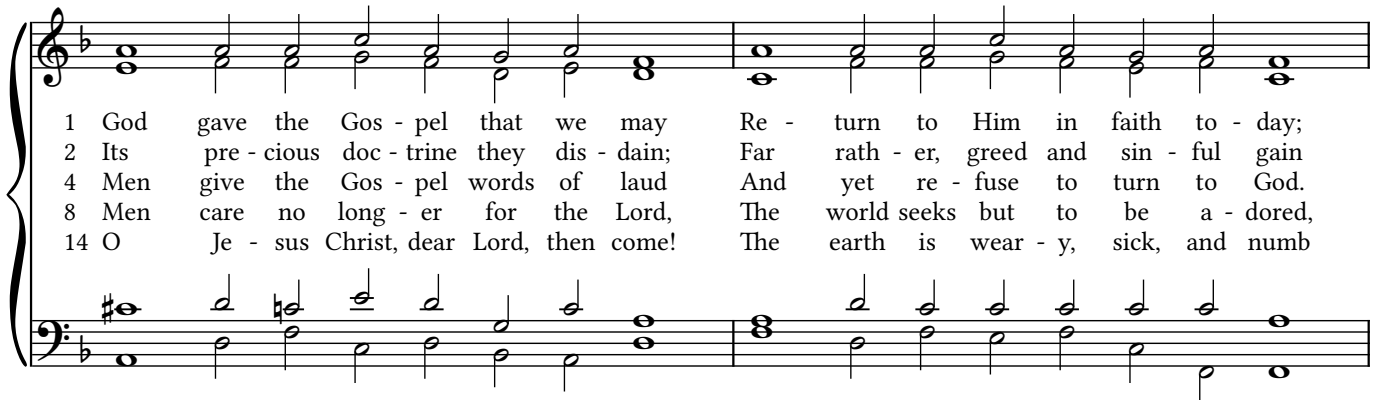


God Gave the Gospel That We May

Gott hat das Evangelium

Musæ Sionæ VIII/213
tr. *Walther's Hymnal*, no. 442

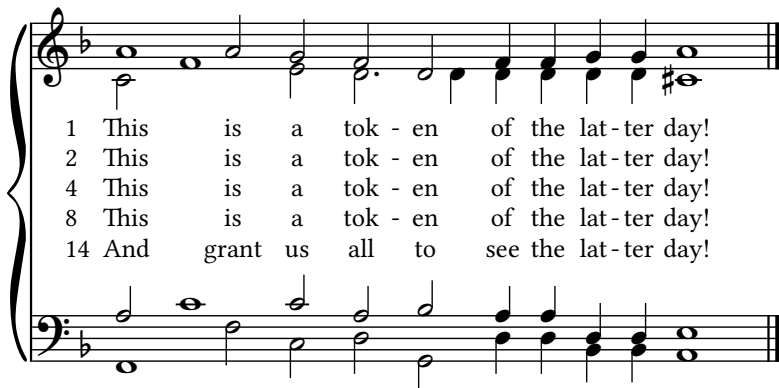
Michael Praetorius (1571–1621)
ed. Jonathan Wessler



1 God gave the Gos - pel that we may Re - turn to Him in faith to - day;
2 Its pre - cious doc - trine they dis - dain; Far rath - er, greed and sin - ful gain
4 Men give the Gos - pel words of laud And yet re - fuse to turn to God.
8 Men care no long - er for the Lord, The world seeks but to be a - dored,
14 O Je - sus Christ, dear Lord, then come! The earth is wear - y, sick, and numb



1 The world holds not this treas - ure fair, For it the man - y do not care;
2 In ev - 'ry sta - tion ram - pant run, While they de - clare, "No harm is done!"
4 In - deed, He is with mock - 'ry met While they de - clare, "There is no threat!"
8 A haught - y spir - it wins the prize, Nor will they blush at tricks and lies.
14 From bear - ing Sa - tan's kind - ling dry! So come and bring their end - ing nigh,



1 This is a tok - en of the lat - ter day!
2 This is a tok - en of the lat - ter day!
4 This is a tok - en of the lat - ter day!
8 This is a tok - en of the lat - ter day!
14 And grant us all to see the lat - ter day!

1 God gave the Gospel that we may
Return to Him in faith today;
The world holds not this treasure fair,
For it the many do not care;
This is a token of the latter day!

2 Its precious doctrine they disdain;
Far rather, greed and sinful gain
In every station rampant run,
While they declare, "No harm is done!"
This is a token of the latter day!

3 Such vice incites the worldly wise
New ruses daily to devise,
For all things that their hearts desire,
To steal or falsely to acquire.
This is a token of the latter day!

4 Men give the Gospel words of laud
And yet refuse to turn to God.
Indeed, He is with mockery met
While they declare, "There is no threat!"
This is a token of the latter day!

5 Corruption thrives on every hand;
Men wreak injustice o'er the land
As if there were no God at all.
The poor to their affliction fall.
This is a token of the latter day!

6 The Church's treasures they receive,
But little profit will these give;
They let the needy starve unfed,
And rob their mouths of daily bread.
This is a token of the latter day!

7 The Church's gifts are God-endowed,
Not instituted by their crowd,
Yet they would take the Church's share;
Behold, what will their greed not dare?
This is a token of the latter day!

8 Men care no longer for the Lord,
The world seeks but to be adored,
A haughty spirit wins the prize,
Nor will they blush at tricks and lies.
This is a token of the latter day!

9 Where is the love of fellow men?
The world is but a robber's den.
All faith and hope are gone indeed,
While they declare, "'Tis gold I need!"
This is a token of the latter day!

10 The world will not soon be deterred;
No man will turn to hear God's Word!
Of nothing else they learn or think
But gluttony of food and drink.
This is a token of the latter day!

11 Their greatest knowledge is in feasts
And imitating shameless beasts—
These things they know to high degree;
The world is full of villainy.
This is a token of the latter day!

12 The lovely sun no longer can
Endure this awful sight to scan:
And so it takes away its glow.
Oh, what a dreadful, sorry show!
This is a token of the latter day!

13 The moon and stars are filled with pain,
Their faces in great sorrow strain.
How ardently they long to be
From all this wicked vision free!
This is a token of the latter day!

14 O Jesus Christ, dear Lord, then come!
The earth is weary, sick, and numb
From bearing Satan's kindling dry!
So come and bring their ending nigh,
And grant us all to see the latter day!